

Sociology Past Papers Solved Short Questions

Past Paper 2015

Q: Answer the following questions?

Q: 1 Structural functionalism with social conflict perspective?

A: 1 Structural Functionalism: It is a sociological perspective about the society. It was pointed out by August Comte. Other sociologists, Emile Durkheim and Herbert Spencer were also contributed a lot in this sociological perspective. Spencer compared society to the human body. Just as the structural parts of the human body _____ the skeleton. Muscles and various internal organs function interdependently to help the entire organism survive; social structures work together to preserve society. the structural functional approach, then, leads sociologists to identify the role of various institutes of the society and their functions.

Social Conflict: It is a sociological perspective about the society. It was pointed out by the father of communism “Karl Marx”. This theory tells us about the social conflict, inequality and change in society, which is always present in the society. Sociologists investigate how factors such as social class, race, ethnicity, gender, sexual orientation, are linked to a society’s unequal

distribution of money, power, education and social status. A conflict analysis rejects the idea that social structure promotes the operation of society as a whole, rather it focuses on some social patterns benefit only few people while hurts others.



Q: 2 Subculture with counter culture?

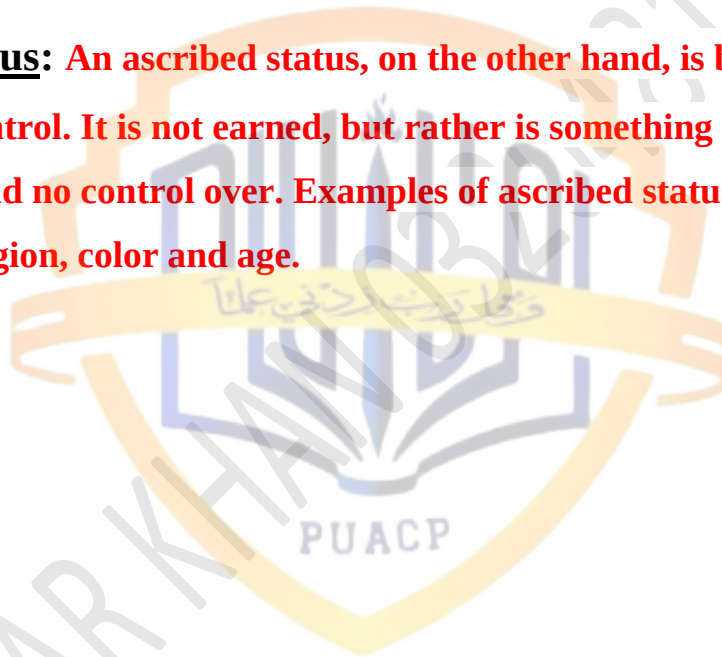
A: 2 Subculture: A subculture refers to a smaller group of people who stand separate from the mainstream culture as they share slightly different beliefs, ideas, traditions, and values. For example, Pakistani culture is a mainstream culture of Pakistan. But, the provincial cultures of Pakistan like; Punjabi culture, Pakhtoon culture, Balochi culture and Sindhi culture are subcultures of Pakistani mainstream culture.

Counter Culture: Countercultures are groups of people who differ in certain ways from the dominant culture and whose norms and values may be incompatible with it. For example, criminal gangs, outlaw biker gangs, rapists' gangs, drug addiction, robbery, theft, open sexuality, (LGBT) (Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, Transgender) movement etc.

Q: 3 Achieved status with ascribed status?

A: 3 Achieved Status: An achieved status is one that is acquired on the basis of merit; it is a position that is earned or chosen and reflects a person's skills, abilities, and efforts. Being a professional athlete, for example, is an achieved status, as is being a lawyer, college professor, or even a criminal.

Ascribed Status: An ascribed status, on the other hand, is beyond an individual's control. It is not earned, but rather is something people are either born with or had no control over. Examples of ascribed status include sex, race, caste, religion, color and age.



Q: 4 Role conflict with role strain?

A: 4 Role Conflict: It is a sociological term, that means conflict between two different roles of different statuses. Likewise; when a person who has two different statuses and their two different roles at the same time. Then it maybe creates contradiction between these two roles of him. This contradiction is called “Role Conflict”. For example, a person who has two statuses of student and son. He will play the roles of both statuses at the same time, then this situation creates a conflict between these two roles.

Role Strain: It is a sociological term, that means strain between two different roles of one status. Likewise; a person who is a student. Student is his status, and the duties and responsibilities related to that status are his roles. When a person plays two different roles of one status at the same time, it maybe creates contradiction between these two roles of him. This contradiction is called “Role Strain”. For example, a person has two different roles of one status. He will play the both roles of one status at the same time, then this situation creates strain between these two roles.

Past Paper 2017

Q: Answer the following questions?

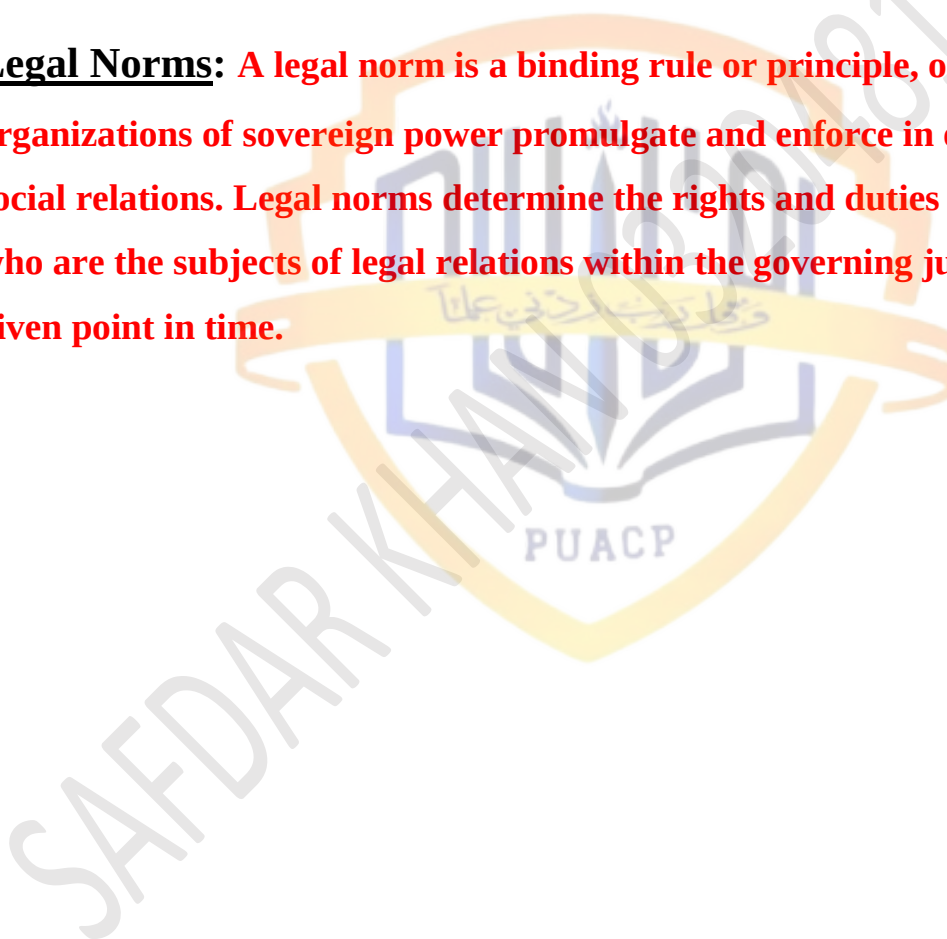
Q: 1 Explain symbolic interactionist perspective with examples?

A: 1 Symbolic Interactionist Perspective: It is a sociological perspective about society. George Herbert Mead pointed out this perspective. symbolic interactionism is how your experiences add subjective meanings to symbols and letters. For example, the word 'dog' is just a series of letters. Through your interactions with the letter's 'dog', you see this as a furry, four-legged canine. The symbolic interactionist perspective is based on the notion that people make sense of their social worlds through communication and social interaction. The exchange of meaning through symbols and language.

Q: 2 Explain the relationship between social norms and legal norms?

A: 2 Social Norms: Social norms are unwritten rules of behavior shared by members of a given group or society. Examples from western culture include: forming a line at store counters, saying 'bless you' when someone sneezes, or holding the door to someone entering a building right after you.

Legal Norms: A legal norm is a binding rule or principle, or norm, that organizations of sovereign power promulgate and enforce in order to regulate social relations. Legal norms determine the rights and duties of individuals who are the subjects of legal relations within the governing jurisdiction at a given point in time.



Q: 3 Briefly explain the relationship between status and role?

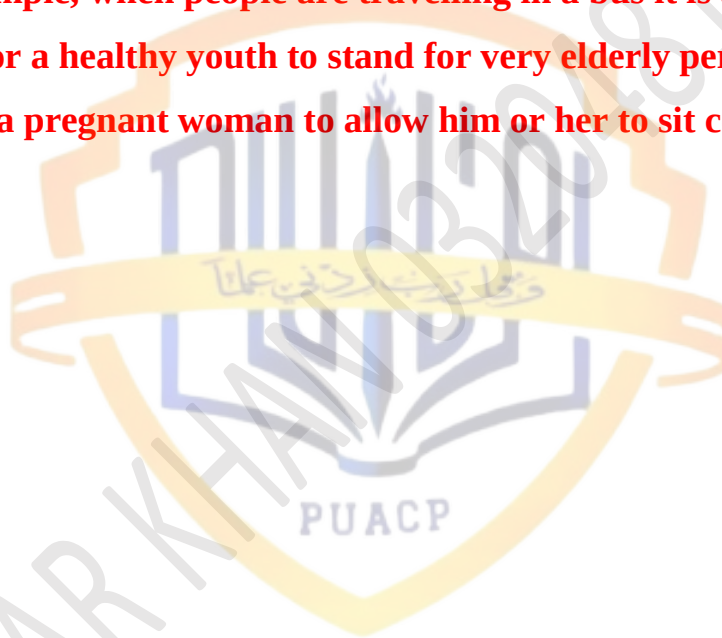
A: 3 Status: According to Horton & Hunt: status is defined as “the rank or position of a person in a group, or of a group in relation to other groups.

Role: According to William & Young: “role is the function of status”.

Relationship between status and role: Status and role both are interlinked and inseparable. These both sociological concepts are interrelated with each other. If a person has a status then it is surely possible that he has also one and more than one role of his status. And if a person plays a role then it means he has a status of that role which he is playing. Without a status there is no role and without a role there is no status. So, both are related with each other. We can't separate them.

Q: 4 Explain informal social control mechanism?

A: 4 Informal Social Control Mechanism: Informal mechanisms of social control are methods that are used by society to put pressure on an individual to behave a certain way, without recourse to formal mechanisms such as the police and the criminal justice system. This can be achieved through the use of peer or community pressure on the individual to adhere to social norms and values. For example, when people are travelling in a bus it is an informal social control for a healthy youth to stand for very elderly person, a sick person or even a pregnant woman to allow him or her to sit comfortably.



Past Paper 2018

Q: Answer the following questions?

Q: 1 Define culture. Explain norms and values as elements of culture?

A: 1 Culture: According to Horton & Hunt: “culture is everything which is socially shared and learned by the members of a society”.

There are many elements of culture, but we will discuss about the norms and values as elements of culture.

Norms: Norms are the rules and regulations which specify the behavior of an individual. These are the expectations of society for “right” behavior. Norms explain what people do and what not to do in a certain situation.

There are further two types of norms:

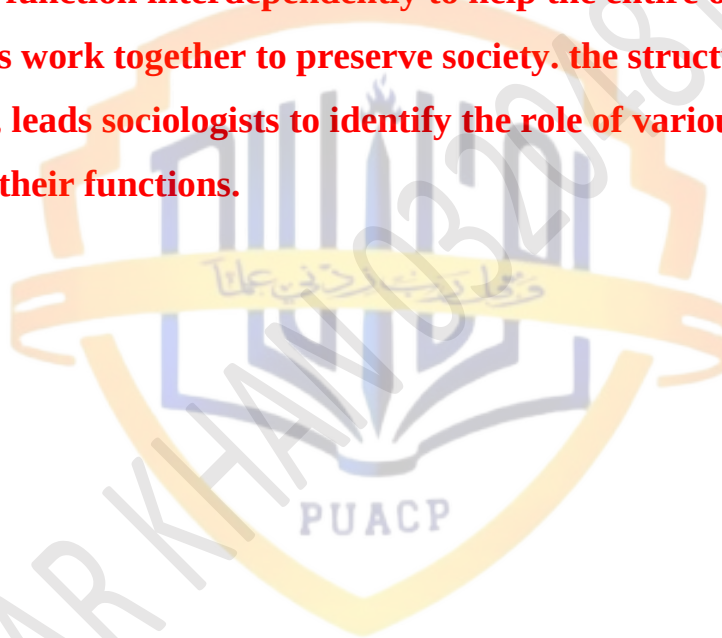
Formal Norms (Folkways & Customs) & Informal Norms (Mores, Taboo, Laws).

Values: Values the general guidelines / principles that guide you to decide what is right and what is wrong. These are standards by which people define what is desirable or undesirable, good or bad, beautiful. A culture's values are its ideas about what is good, right, fair and just.



Q: 2 Briefly explain basic idea of structural functionalism?

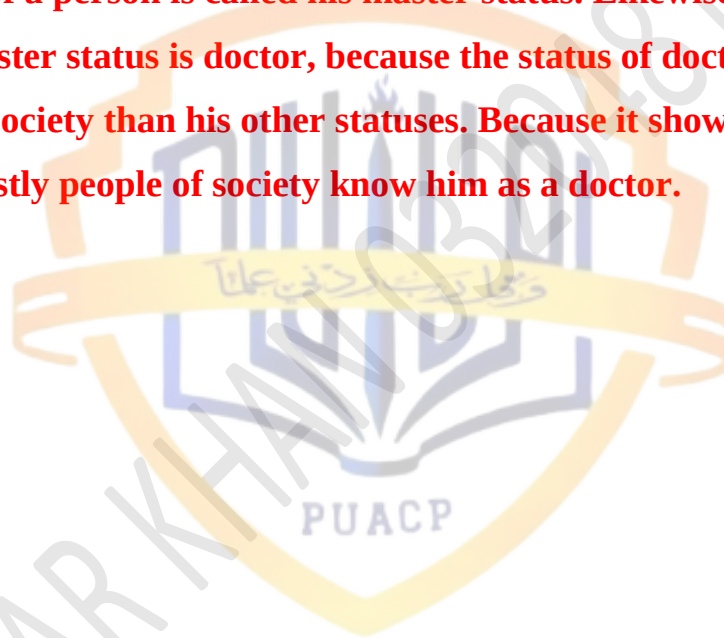
A: 2 Structural Functionalism: It is a sociological perspective about the society. It was pointed out by August Comte. Other sociologists, Emile Durkheim and Herbert Spencer were also contributed a lot in this sociological perspective. Spencer compared society to the human body. Just as the structural parts of the human body____ the skeleton. Muscles and various internal organs function interdependently to help the entire organism survive; social structures work together to preserve society. the structural functional approach, then, leads sociologists to identify the role of various institutes of the society and their functions.



SAFDAR KHAN

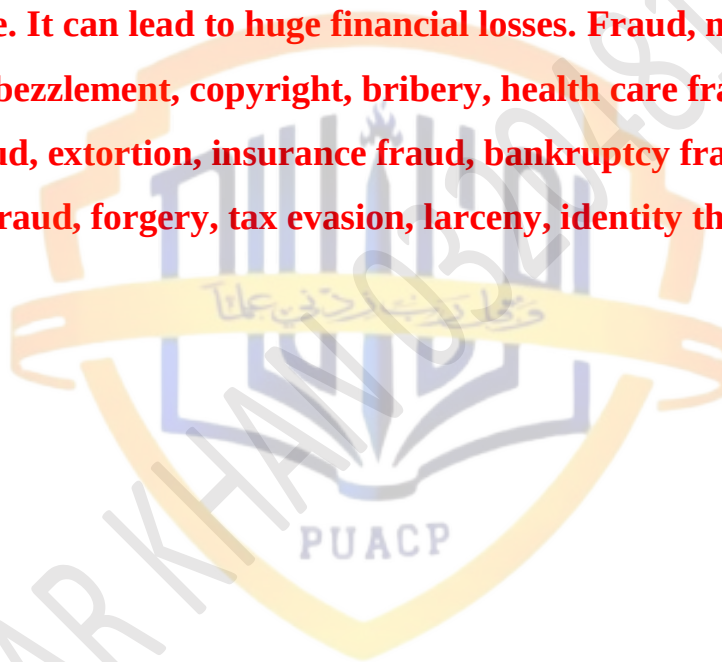
Q: 3 With an example explain Master Status?

A: 3 Master Status: It is a sociological concept. A master status is a status that has special importance for social identity of a person. It is often shaping a person's entire life. For example, if a person has different statuses like, he is a student, a son, a father, a husband, a friend, a doctor etc. All these statuses identify the social identity of a person. In these statuses, which shows the social identity of a person is called his master status. Likewise; in these statuses the master status is doctor, because the status of doctor has more importance in society than his other statuses. Because it shows his identity in the society. Mostly people of society know him as a doctor.



Q: 4 Briefly explain white collar crimes?

A: 4 White Collar Crimes: It is a term that is propounded by an American criminologist Edwin Sutherland in 1939. These are the crimes that are related to the businesspeople, government and private professionals and educated class of society. The businesspeople, government and private professionals and highly educated people are involved in white collar crimes. It is not a victimless crime. It can lead to huge financial losses. Fraud, money laundering, embezzlement, copyright, bribery, health care fraud, cybercrime, credit-card fraud, extortion, insurance fraud, bankruptcy fraud, telemarketing fraud, forgery, tax evasion, larceny, identity theft etc.



Past Paper 2019

Q: Answer the following questions?

Q: 1 Define sociology with reference to different sociologists?

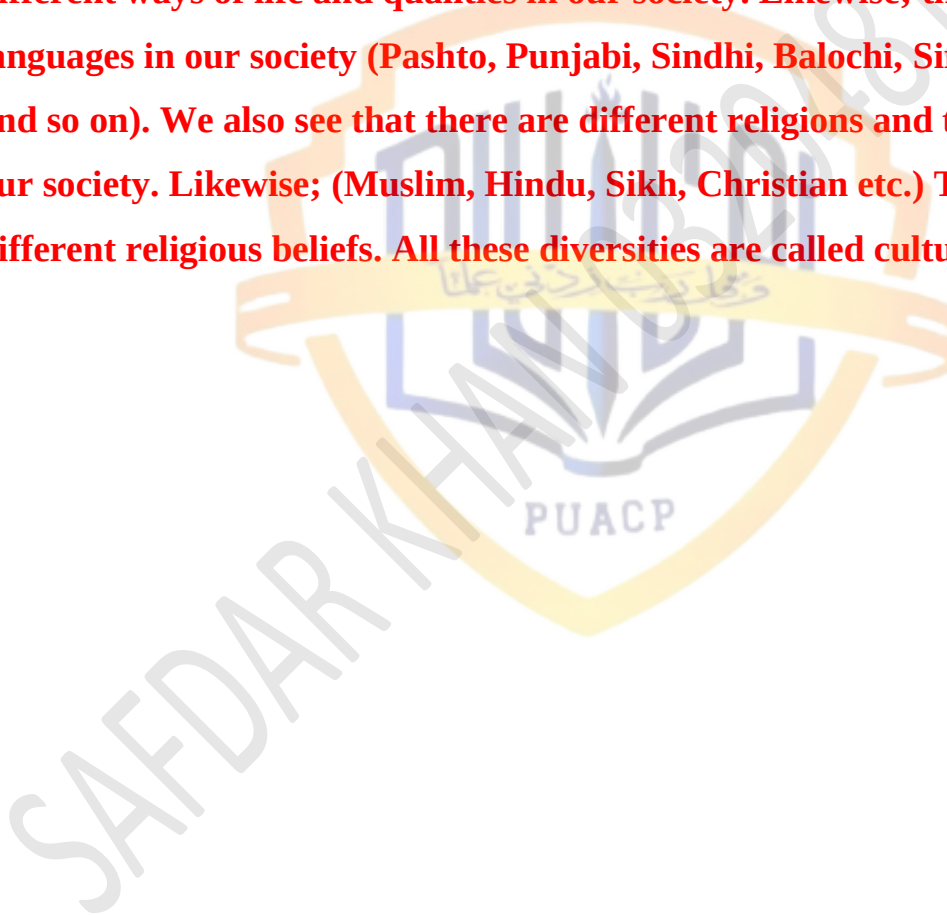
A: 1 Sociology: “Sociology is the systematic study of human society and social interaction”. The word sociology is derived from Latin word ‘Socius’ means companion or association or Greek word ‘Logos’ means study. Thus, etymological meaning of sociology is “The science of society”. The French sociologist August Comte is traditionally known as ‘Father of Sociology’ as he coined the term ‘Sociology’ in 1838. He is also considered the founder of modern sociology. He called it “Social Physics”.

Different definitions of sociology by different famous sociologists:

- 1. Sociology is the science of society or of social phenomenon. (L.F. Ward).**
- 2. The subject matter of sociology is the inter-action of human minds. (L.T. Hobhouse).**
- 3. Sociology is the study of relationship between man and his human environment. (H.P. Fairchild).**
- 4. Sociology may be defined as a body of scientific knowledge about human relationships. (J.F. Cuber).**
- 5. Sociology deals with behavior of men in groups. (Kimball young).**

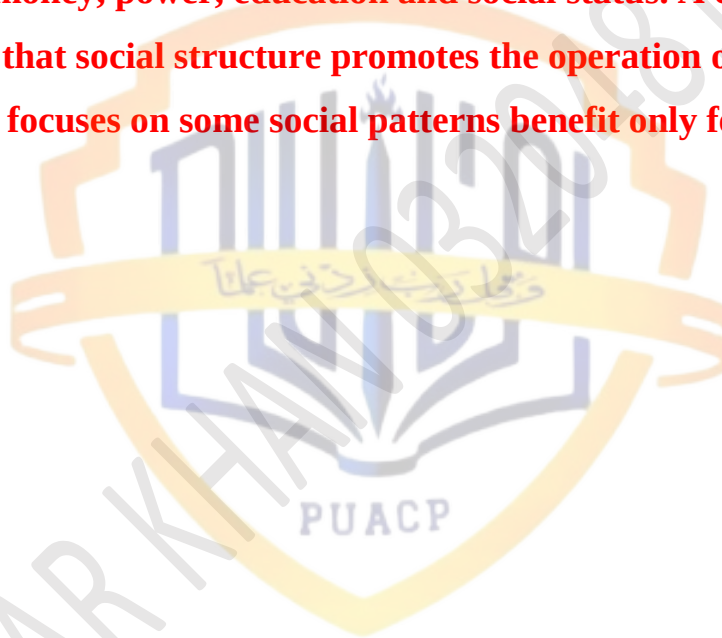
Q: 2 What is cultural diversity?

A: 2 Cultural Diversity: It is a sociological term which means the existence of different cultural and ethnic groups within a society. It is also mean that different people of different cultures are living in a same society. Religion, language, age, race, gender, sexual orientation are the examples of cultural diversity. We see that there are different people of different cultures and their different ways of life and qualities in our society. Likewise; there are different languages in our society (Pashto, Punjabi, Sindhi, Balochi, Siraiki, Kashmiri and so on). We also see that there are different religions and their believers in our society. Likewise; (Muslim, Hindu, Sikh, Christian etc.) They all have different religious beliefs. All these diversities are called cultural diversity.



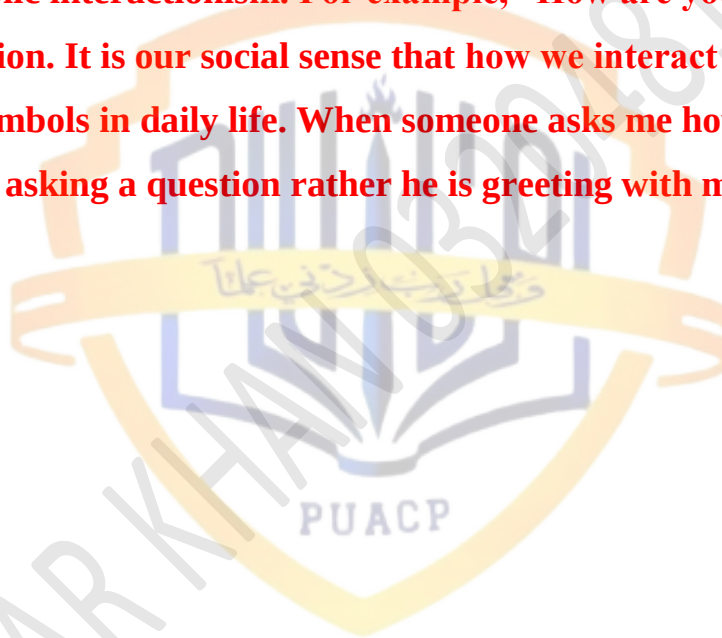
Q: 3 What is role conflict? Give brief explanation?

A: 3 Social Conflict: It is a sociological perspective about the society. It was pointed out by the father of communism “Karl Marx”. This theory tells us about the social conflict, inequality and change in society, which is always present in the society. Sociologists investigate how factors such as social class, race, ethnicity, gender, sexual orientation, are linked to a society’s unequal distribution of money, power, education and social status. A conflict analysis rejects the idea that social structure promotes the operation of society as a whole, rather it focuses on some social patterns benefit only few people while hurts others.



Q: 4 What is ethnomethodology?

A: 4 Ethnomethodology: It is a sociological term propounded by an American Sociologist Harold Garfinkel (1917-2011). He coined the term in 1954. It is a branch of social science which is concerned with exploring how people interact with the world and make sense of reality. We can also say that it deals with the “ways we use to understand” the society we live in. It is very closed to symbolic interactionism. For example, “How are you?” is a greeting, and not a question. It is our social sense that how we interact with the people’s gestures and symbols in daily life. When someone asks me how are you? It means he is not asking a question rather he is greeting with me.



Past Paper 2020

Q: Answer the following questions?

Q: 1 What is the relationship of Sociology and Political Science?

A: 1 Sociology and Political Science: Sociology is a general social science. It is the science of sociology. It is considered that sociology is the study of social relationship and social institutions. On the other hand, political science is the study of state and government. Power structure, political system, type of the government, its policies and international relation fall in the domain of political science. It also employs the method of sociological research to investigate the content of political behavior. It treats political institutions as part of the social system. Political science provides laws to the society for social welfare, social development, ensure peace, social order, harmony and removal of poverty and crimes while sociology provides data which becomes bases for law making. Political sociology is an integral part sociology which has progressively transform political science in the directions of wider attentions to imperial reality.

Q: 2 Define Social Problem and give examples?

A: 2 Social Problem: A social problem is any condition or behavior that has negative consequences for large numbers of people and that is generally recognized as a condition or behavior that needs to be addressed. This definition has both an objective component and a subjective component. It may also be defined as “A social problem is an issue within the society that makes it difficult for people to achieve their full potential. “Poverty, unemployment, unequal opportunity, racism, and malnutrition are examples of social problem. So are substandard housing, employment discrimination, and child abuse and neglect. The term “social problem” is usually taken to refer to social conditions that disrupt or damage society ---- crime, racism, and the like. “Social problem” is the title of an undergraduate course taught at many colleges; a typical course discusses what is known about a series of conditions considered social problem.

Q: 3 What is the concept of “SELF” given by C.H. Cooley?

A: 3 Looking Glass Self: It is a theory of socialization in sociology.

According to this theory: Others represent a mirror (which people used to call a “looking glass”) in which we can see ourselves. What we think of ourselves, then, depends on what we think others think of us. For example, if we think others see us as clever, we will think ourselves in the same way. But if we feel they think of us as clumsy, then that is how we will see ourselves. Cooley used the phrase looking glass self to mean a self-image based on how we think others see us.

Our sense of self develops from interaction with others. The term looking glass self was coined by Cooley to describe the process by which a sense of self develops. The looking glass self contains three elements:

- 1. We imagine how we appear to those around us.**
- 2. We interpret other’s reactions.**
- 3. We interpret other’s reactions.**

Q: 4 Differentiate between Role Conflict and Role Strain?

A: 4 Role Conflict: It is a sociological term, that means conflict between two different roles of different statuses. Likewise; when a person who has two different statuses and their two different roles at the same time. Then it maybe creates contradiction between these two roles of him. This contradiction is called “Role Conflict”. For example, a person who has two statuses of student and son. He will play the roles of both statuses at the same time, then this situation creates a conflict between these two roles.

Role Strain: It is a sociological term, that means strain between two different roles of one status. Likewise; a person who is a student. Student is his status, and the duties and responsibilities related to that status are his roles. When a person plays two different roles of one status at the same time, it maybe creates contradiction between these two roles of him. This contradiction is called “Role Strain”. For example, a person has two different roles of one status. He will play the both roles of one status at the same time, then this situation creates strain between these two roles.

Past Paper 2021

Q: Answer the following questions?

Q: 1 Differentiate between the following?

- a) Ascribed Status.
- b) Achieved Status.

A: 1 Achieved Status: An achieved status is one that is acquired on the basis of merit; it is a position that is earned or chosen and reflects a person's skills, abilities, and efforts. Being a professional athlete, for example, is an achieved status, as is being a lawyer, college professor, or even a criminal.

Ascribed Status: An ascribed status, on the other hand, is beyond an individual's control. It is not earned, but rather is something people are either born with or had no control over. Examples of ascribed status include sex, race, caste, religion, color and age.

Q: 2 Write a note on the following?

- a) Cultural Relativism.
- b) Cultural Lag.

Cultural Relativism: Cultural relativism is the belief that every culture is equally valid, so you have no right to impose your culture's values on other cultures." Cultural relativism not judging a culture with the standards of your own culture rather try to understand it on its own rules and regulations. Cultural relativism is the idea that a person's beliefs, values, and practices should be understood based on that person's own culture, rather than judged against the criteria of another.

Cultural Lag: It refers to the phenomenon that occurs when changes in material culture occur at a faster rate than the changes in non-material culture.

In other words, cultural lag is when technological advancement occurs faster than changes/development in norms, values and the belief system. Let's look at an example to better understand cultural lag.

According to sociologist William Ogburn, technology has tremendous impact on society and in creating social change; he said that technology changes society by three processes: invention, discovery, and diffusion. The resulting

changes of these processes, however, may “lag” behind social changes that result from any of the three processes. In other words, it takes time for us—in terms of the way we go about living—to ‘catch up’ with technology, Ogburn referred to this as cultural lag.



Q: 3 What is social interaction? Highlight Processes of social interaction?

A: 3 Definitions of Social interaction:

- 1. Dawson and Gettys define Social Interaction as "it is a process by which men interpenetrate the minds of each other".**
- 2. According to Merrill, "Social-interaction is the general process whereby two or more persons are in a meaningful contact, as a result of which their behavior is modified however slightly."**
- 3. According to Corkiness. "Social interaction is such a process which influences the overt behavior or state of mind of the individuals."**

Social interaction is an event which changes the behavior and attitude of the interacting persons. It is a social relationship among at least two persons. It changes the societal conditions of lives of the people. Interaction is the soul of social life and relationship. It produces group which is the foundation stone of society.

Social Interaction Process

Social interaction usually takes place in the forms of

- 1. Cooperation.**
- 2. Competition.**
- 3. Conflict.**
- 4. Accommodation.**
- 5. Assimilation.**

These forms of social interaction are called “social processes”. Social processes are the ways in which individuals and groups interact, adjust, readjust and establish relationships and pattern of behavior which are again modified through social interactions. As Ginsberg says, “Social processes mean the various modes of interaction between individuals or groups”.

According to Horton and Hunt, “The term social process refers to the repetitive form of behaviors which are commonly found in social life”.

1. Cooperation:

- 1. The basic form of human contact in society is co-operation.**
- 2. Cooperation is the process in which people work together to achieve shared goals.**
- 3. Cooperation is a social process that gets things done; no group can complete its tasks or achieve its goals without cooperation from its members.**
- 4. We find co-operation in almost every aspect of our life.**

5. In a baseball game, for example, a team will work together (cooperation) while attempting to achieve a victory (a goal that only one team can attain). Customer cooperates with shopkeeper, for business purpose, patient with doctor, the students with teacher, mother with child etc.

2. Competition:

1. Competition is a process by which two or more people attempt to achieve a goal that only one can attain.
2. Horton & Hunt explains that competition is struggle for possession for rewards which are limited in supply, goods, status, power, and love.
3. Most sociologists view competition as a positive thing - one that can motivate people to achieve goals. However, competition can also lead to psychological stress, a lack of cooperation in social relationships, inequality and even conflict.
4. Examples: Elections, Exams, jobs, business, jobs, exams, CSS, PCS, sports, better living conditions, cheaper rates, sales and marketing competition etc. Coke & Pepsi, KFC & McDonalds. Banks, Samsung, Nokia & Q Mobile.

3. Conflict:

- 1. Conflict is a social process in which individuals or groups seek their ends by directly challenging the antagonist by violence or threat of violence.**
- 2. Conflict involves disagreement and disharmony, which results due to differences in ideology, living standard, and other social factors. It is a universal phenomenon, an ever- present reality, taking place both at micro and macro levels.**
- 3. Conflict involves clash of interest between individuals in a social group like in a family or between groups or societies.**
- 4. It results due to power imbalance, due to unfair distribution of resources. Here, it produces social class and stratification.**
- 5. Conflict may be between males and females, youngster and older generation; between different religious, ethnic and, political groups.**
 - Examples: fighting, killing, beating, quarreling**
 - Litigation on disputes is found in courts**
 - War, family disputes, sectarian conflicts, Revolutions.**

4. Accommodation:

- 1. The suspension of rivalry between the parties for temporary or permanent period is called accommodation.**
- 2. People may decide to consciously avoid the source of conflict thereby arriving at an agreement to live accepting one another, co-exist at relative peace, avoiding overt conflict.**
- 3. Accommodation is a social process whereby people try to accept one another, avoiding the sources of conflict to live in peaceful coexistence.**
- 4. It is a conscious adjustment and compromise among conflicting groups so that they can live with one another without overt conflict.**

Truce: Problem remains unsolved & fighting parties stop hostility.

Compromise: on mill owner –labor, India Pakistan on Trade,

Arbitration: conflict is resolved by mediator efforts of third party. UN, USA, Pakistan among Arab countries fights,

Toleration:

5. Assimilation:

- 1. Assimilation is the fusion or blending of two previously distinct groups into one.**
 - 2. Assimilation is a social process whereby a group of individuals learns and accepts the values, norms, of another group and becomes sometimes virtually identical with the dominant groups.**
 - 3. Assimilation involves the acceptance or the internalizing of the larger or dominant group's culture, values and life styles by the smaller or minority group.**
 - 4. In this age of globalization there are westernization processes, whereby peoples of the Third World are taking up the values, notions and practices of the Industrialized West.**
- Assimilation of two cultural groups, Pakistan-India migration**
 - Rural people migrated to urban areas assimilate in urban.**
 - Food, dressing and marriage patterns, religious celebrations etc.**

Past Paper 2022

Q: 1 Answer the following questions?

Q: 1 Sociological Perspectives and its benefits?

A: 1 Structural Functionalism: Structural functionalism is a macro-level theory that sees society as an interconnected system with each part having a different function while still working together.

Benefits: The strengths of structural functionalism are that it can accurately model many aspects of society, and that it relates society to other topics of study. It shows how the individual's and society's needs are met by various organizations and how these organizations are interrelated.

Social Conflict: Social conflict theory sees social life as a competition and focuses on the distribution of resources, power, and inequality.

Benefits: Social conflict theory plays a position role, when properly understood, in promoting groups to find common ground, form alliances, define core values, identify differences in view point, set group boundaries, and inform strategies for achieving expected change.

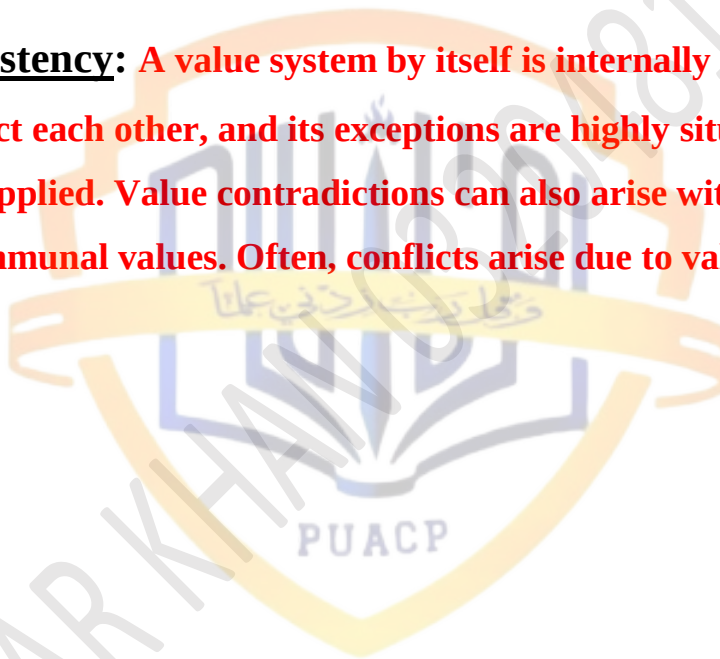
Symbolic Interactionist: Social scientists consider symbolic interaction theory as a framework for building theories that see society as a product of everyday human interactions. This theory focuses on how social interactions and people assign meanings to things around them based on interpretation of their interactions with others.

Benefits: The advantage of symbolic interaction is that in contrast to other social theories it does not pose a theory of 1 society but, rather, focuses on individual acts and what goes on between people. This limited world view is why it will be useful to practitioners.

Q: 2 Values and Value inconsistency?

A: 2 Values: Values are a culture's standard for discerning what is good and just in society. Values are deeply embedded and critical for transmitting and teaching a culture's beliefs. Beliefs are the tenets or convictions that people hold to be true.

Value Inconsistency: A value system by itself is internally inconsistent if its values contradict each other, and its exceptions are highly situational and inconsistently applied. Value contradictions can also arise within systems of personal or communal values. Often, conflicts arise due to value systems contradictions.



Q: 3 Subculture and Counterculture?

A: 3 Subculture: A subculture refers to a smaller group of people who stand separate from the mainstream culture as they share slightly different beliefs, ideas, traditions, and values. For example, Pakistani culture is a mainstream culture of Pakistan. But, the provincial cultures of Pakistan like; Punjabi culture, Pakhtoon culture, Balochi culture and Sindhi culture are subcultures of Pakistani mainstream culture.

Counter Culture: Countercultures are groups of people who differ in certain ways from the dominant culture and whose norms and values may be incompatible with it. For example, criminal gangs, outlaw biker gangs, rapists' gangs, drug addiction, robbery, theft, open sexuality, (LGBT) (Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, Transgender) movement etc.

Q: 4 Socialization and its importance?

A: 4 Socialization: Socialization is the process through which people are taught to be proficient members of a society. It describes the ways that people come to understand societal norms and expectations, to accept society's beliefs, and to be aware of societal values.

Importance of Socialization:

Upholding Societies and Cultures: Socialization is crucial for healthy individual and societal development. It plays a key role in individual development, as both nature (genetic and hormonal makeup) and nurture (social environment) influence who we are. It is through socialization that individuals learn the expected norms and customs of a group or society through social interaction, thereby upholding societies and cultures.

Learning Cultural Norms and Values: Socialization is the process through which people are taught to be proficient members of a society. It encompasses learning and teaching, and is the means by which social and cultural continuity are attained. Individuals come to understand societal norms and expectations, accept societal beliefs, and become aware of societal values through socialization.

Development of Personality: Socialization is essential for the development of an individual's personality. It represents the whole process of learning throughout the life course and is a central influence on behavior, beliefs, and actions of both adults and children.

Role in Individual and Society: Socialization is the process through which people are taught to be proficient members of a society. It describes the ways that people come to understand societal norms and expectations, accept societal beliefs, and be aware of societal values.

Agents of Socialization: Socialization occurs through direct interactions with social groups, such as families and peers, as well as through formal and informal institutions like schools, workplaces, and the media. These agents play a significant role in socializing the population by communicating and reinforcing cultural norms and values.

Socialization across the Life Course: Socialization is a continuous process that occurs through interaction with many individuals and groups. It is essential for the development of the self of the newborn and the formation of their personality, rooted in social behavior rather than biological or hereditary factors.

Q: 5 Media as an agent of socialization?

A: 5 Media as an Agent of Socialization: The mass media, including newspapers, magazines, comic books, television, radio, movies, and the internet, serves as a powerful agent of socialization. It plays a significant role in shaping the behavior and influencing the ways people think. Here are some key points regarding the role of media as an agent of socialization:

Transmission of Culture and Information: Mass media serves as a means of communication that spreads messages to the audiences and carries out information to the people in society. It transmits cultural norms, values, and information to a wide audience, influencing their perceptions and behaviors.

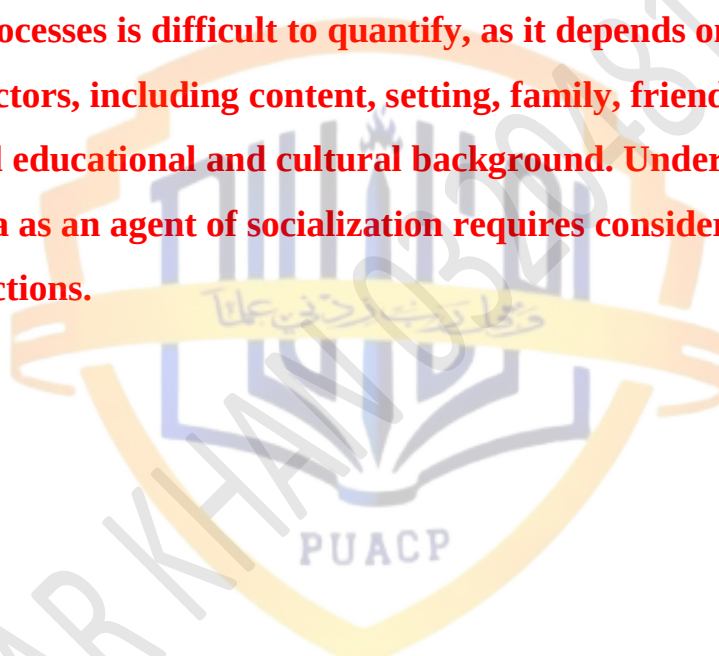
Influence on Behavior and Thinking: The content of mass media is powerful and has the ability to shape people's behavior and influence the ways in which they think. Media content can significantly impact an individual's lifestyle and behavior, making it a potent force in the socialization process.

Impersonal Information Distribution: Mass media distributes

impersonal information to a wide audience through various channels such as television, newspapers, radio, and the internet. This widespread dissemination of information contributes to the socialization of individuals by exposing them to a broad range of cultural and societal influences.

Challenges in Quantifying Influence: The function of media in

socialization processes is difficult to quantify, as it depends on the interaction of numerous factors, including content, setting, family, friends, personality, motivation, and educational and cultural background. Understanding the impact of media as an agent of socialization requires consideration of these complex interactions.



Q: 6 Latent Functions of Crime?

A: 6 Followings are the latent functions of crime:

1. Social integration: Social integration refers to the cohesion that members of society experience when they share a collective expectation of the norms and values within their community.

People tend to come together in this way when, for example, someone has committed a terrible crime. There is a shared sense of anger towards the breach of morals that the criminal has committed.

2. Social regulation: Social regulation is one of the functions that societal structures carry out in managing public interests like the environment, health, education, and more. A common example of using crime as a form of social regulation is through staging public trials.

By punishing someone for their crimes in this way, enforcers of the law are sending a warning message to the rest of society that such deviant behavior won't be tolerated.

3. **Social change**: Another important function of crime is in the fact that it can bring about social change. Deviant behavior causes people to reflect on what is or isn't allowed within a particular society, allowing them to discover when the law doesn't line up with the collective sentiments of the majority.

This can lead to necessary legal reform which ends up benefiting the community and its members.



Past Paper 2023

Q: 1 Answer the following questions?

Q: 1 Relation of Sociology with Psychology?

A: 1 Sociology and psychology are closely related disciplines, each offering unique perspectives on human behavior and society. Here's how they are related:

Similarities Between Sociology and Psychology: Both sociology and psychology require similar skills, such as critical thinking, reasoning, conducting and analyzing research, and effective communication. They also share similarities in terms of job outlook and projected growth rates.

Differences in Focus: Sociology focuses on the study of entire groups and social processes within society, while psychology primarily studies individual behavior and mental processes.

Interdisciplinary Relationship: The relationship between sociology and psychology is close, with both disciplines being interdependent. Psychologists analyze the role of society and social customs in the development of social behavior, while sociologists take the help of psychology when studying changes in social structure.

Contributory Sciences: Sociology and psychology are considered contributory sciences, with psychology being defined as the study of human behavior and sociology studying society from a sociological point of view [2].

Overlap in Domain: Despite their contrasting emphases on groups and individuals, there is an inherent overlap between the domains of sociology and psychology. Both disciplines involve concerns of the other discipline, particularly in social psychology, which exists as a subspecialty in both fields.

Mutual Dependence: Psychology trends support to sociology, and sociology extends help to psychology. Both disciplines are deeply related to each other, and they depend on each other for their existence.

Q: 2 Significance of Socialization?

A: 2 Significance of Socialization:

Upholding Societies and Cultures: Socialization is crucial for healthy individual and societal development. It plays a key role in individual development, as both nature (genetic and hormonal makeup) and nurture (social environment) influence who we are. It is through socialization that individuals learn the expected norms and customs of a group or society through social interaction, thereby upholding societies and cultures.

Learning Cultural Norms and Values: Socialization is the process through which people are taught to be proficient members of a society. It encompasses learning and teaching, and is the means by which social and cultural continuity are attained. Individuals come to understand societal norms and expectations, accept societal beliefs, and become aware of societal values through socialization.

Development of Personality: Socialization is essential for the development of an individual's personality. It represents the whole process of learning throughout the life course and is a central influence on behavior, beliefs, and actions of both adults and children.

Role in Individual and Society: Socialization is the process through which people are taught to be proficient members of a society. It describes the ways that people come to understand societal norms and expectations, accept societal beliefs, and be aware of societal values.

Agents of Socialization: Socialization occurs through direct interactions with social groups, such as families and peers, as well as through formal and informal institutions like schools, workplaces, and the media. These agents play a significant role in socializing the population by communicating and reinforcing cultural norms and values.

Socialization across the Life Course: Socialization is a continuous process that occurs through interaction with many individuals and groups. It is essential for the development of the self of the newborn and the formation of their personality, rooted in social behavior rather than biological or hereditary factors.

Q: 3 Illiteracy as a Social Problem?

A: 3 Illiteracy as a Social Problem: Illiteracy is a significant social problem with far-reaching consequences for individuals and society as a whole. Here are some key points highlighting the significance of illiteracy as a social issue:

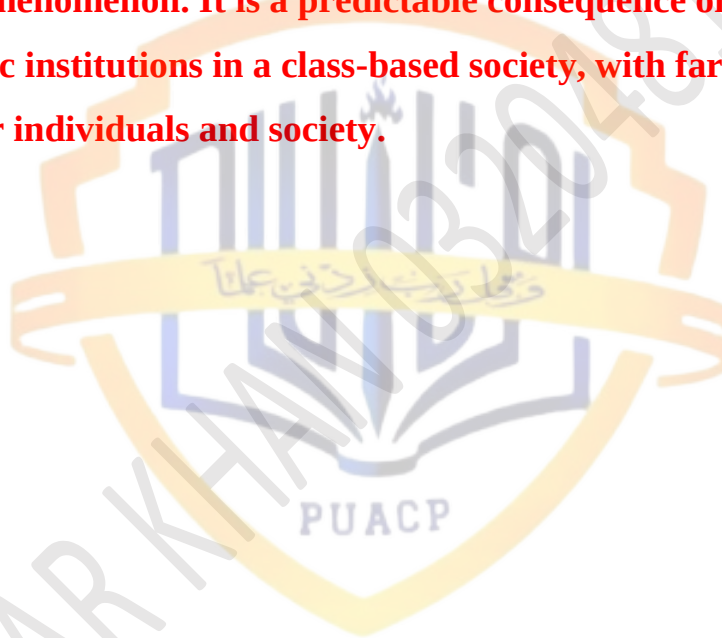
Impact on Access to Information and Opportunities: People who are illiterate have a limited ability to obtain and understand important information such as emergency warnings, medication dosages, or workplace instructions. This lack of literacy skills hinders their access to crucial information and opportunities.

Economic and Social Implications: Illiteracy increases the country's unemployment rate and lowers community involvement and participation in social and political issues. It inhibits economic and social progress, hindering the development of both individuals and the country as a whole.

Inter-generational Transmission and Educational Disparities: Illiteracy can be perpetuated inter-generationally, as there is often little to no value given to education within illiterate families. The quality of early childhood education is often determined by economic status, leading to disparities in educational opportunities.

Health and Social Well-being: Illiteracy can impact social skills, health, and economic status later in life. It is associated with a range of negative consequences, including lower income, higher likelihood of imprisonment, increased crime, disease, poverty, and social unrest.

Structural Interpretation and Social Circumstances: Illiteracy is best understood in social structural terms, rather than as an individual psychological phenomenon. It is a predictable consequence of the routine working of basic institutions in a class-based society, with far-reaching implications for individuals and society.



Q: 4 Dysfunctions and their latent functions?

A: 4 In sociology, the concepts of manifest and latent functions, as well as dysfunctions, are essential for understanding the various consequences of social actions and institutions. Here's a breakdown of these concepts:

Manifest Functions: Manifest functions are the intended and recognized consequences of social actions or institutions. They are the explicit and conscious purposes for which an element of a social system exists. For example, the intended function of friendship is usually companionship, which is a manifest function.

Latent Functions: Latent functions are the unintended or unrecognized consequences of social actions or institutions. They are not consciously intended, but nonetheless have a beneficial effect on society. These functions are often hard to observe and measure. For instance, broadening one's literary or cinematic scope as a result of a friendship is a latent function.

Dysfunctions: Dysfunctions can be manifest or latent. While functions have a positive effect on society, dysfunctions have a negative effect and are unintended or unrecognized. Dysfunctions are disruptions in society and its parts that threaten social stability. For example, a shopping center becoming a magnet for criminal activity like shoplifting and muggings represents a dysfunction.

Robert Merton's Theory: American sociologist Robert K. Merton introduced the concepts of manifest function, latent function, and dysfunction in his book "Social Theory and Social Structure." He emphasized the importance of understanding both the intended and unintended consequences of social actions and institutions for a comprehensive understanding of society.



Q: 5 Media as an Agent of Socialization?

A: 5 Media as an Agent of Socialization: The mass media, including newspapers, magazines, comic books, television, radio, movies, and the internet, serves as a powerful agent of socialization. It plays a significant role in shaping the behavior and influencing the ways people think. Here are some key points regarding the role of media as an agent of socialization:

Transmission of Culture and Information: Mass media serves as a means of communication that spreads messages to the audiences and carries out information to the people in society. It transmits cultural norms, values, and information to a wide audience, influencing their perceptions and behaviors.

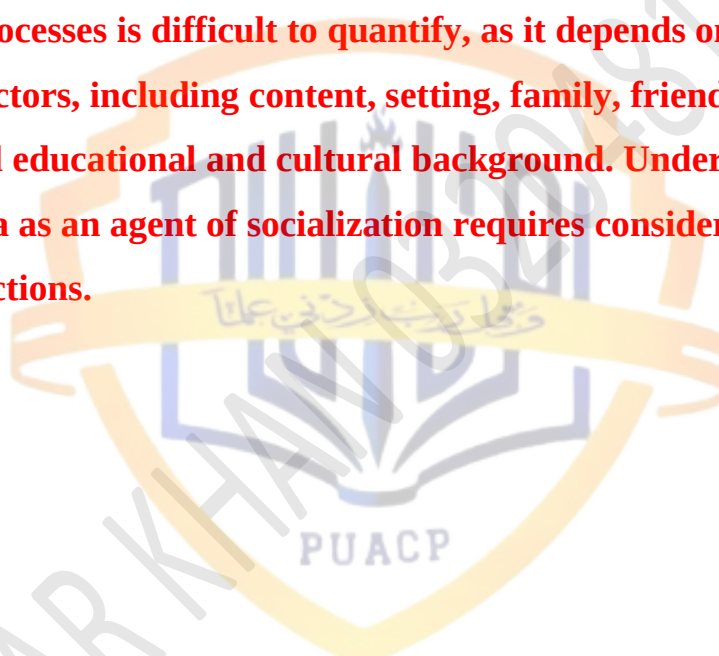
Influence on Behavior and Thinking: The content of mass media is powerful and has the ability to shape people's behavior and influence the ways in which they think. Media content can significantly impact an individual's lifestyle and behavior, making it a potent force in the socialization process.

Impersonal Information Distribution: Mass media distributes

impersonal information to a wide audience through various channels such as television, newspapers, radio, and the internet. This widespread dissemination of information contributes to the socialization of individuals by exposing them to a broad range of cultural and societal influences.

Challenges in Quantifying Influence: The function of media in

socialization processes is difficult to quantify, as it depends on the interaction of numerous factors, including content, setting, family, friends, personality, motivation, and educational and cultural background. Understanding the impact of media as an agent of socialization requires consideration of these complex interactions.



Q: 6 Mores and Folkways?

A: 6 Mores and Folkways: In sociology, informal norms can be divided into two distinct groups: folkways and mores. These terms were coined by American sociologist William Graham Sumner and are widely used to understand social norms today.

Folkways: Folkways are informal rules and norms that, while not offensive to violate, are expected to be followed. They are standards of behavior that are socially approved but not morally significant. Examples of folkways include cultural food habits, appropriate greetings, and customary behavior for the use of the telephone. Violating folkways may raise eyebrows, but it generally does not result in severe punishment or social ostracism. They are more flexible and may change over time, and are often followed without much thought.

Mores: Mores, pronounced "more-rays," are also informal rules that are not written, but when violated, result in severe punishments and social sanctions upon the individuals, such as social and religious exclusions. Mores are stricter and more important than folkways, and they are considered morally right or wrong within a culture or society. They are deeply ingrained in a culture and are often seen as more fundamental to a society's values and beliefs. Violating mores can result in severe punishment or social ostracism, and people feel strongly about them.